

Cinematic Video

Workflow

One-page roadmap for planning, shooting, and editing

The cinematic look starts before you press record. This guide turns the script into a simple three-phase workflow and keeps the focus on planning, capture, and editing.

80 / 10 / 10

Planning 80%

Recording 10%

Final Touches 10%

Plan first. Shoot with intent. Polish last.

Follow me

@alvinojoy

▶ @alvinojoy

📷 @alvinojoy

📧 alvin.ojoy

📱 @alvinojoy10

01 Phase

Pre-Production

1

Define the Goal

Write one clear sentence about what the audience should feel. Example: Inspire beginners to enjoy unwinding alone with music.

2

Outline the Story

Map 5 or 6 key moments for a 30 to 90-second video so the sequence feels intentional instead of random.

3

Build the Shot List

Match each moment with a camera angle. Start wide, then move closer to reveal action and emotion.

4

Storyboard the Flow

Sketch stick figures or collect reference images so every shot has a visual target before filming starts.

02 Phase

Production

Focus While Shooting

Lighting

Use window light first, or shape the scene with key, fill, and backlight.

Framing

Place the subject on a line or intersection of a 3x3 grid for more dynamic composition.

Movement

Use slow pans or a towel-slide phone move to add polish without expensive gear.

Simple Gear Stack

Phone + tripod is enough to get started. Precision matters more than fancy gear when the plan, framing, and light are working together.

03 Phase

Post-Production

1

Music First

Pick a track that sets the mood, place it on the timeline first, and cut clips to the beat for instant flow.

2

Use Clean Transitions

Lean on straight cuts, fades to black, or cross-dissolves instead of flashy wipes.

3

Color Grade for Emotion

Use app tools or LUTs to shape the cinematic feel. Teal shadows and warm highlights are a popular starting point.

4

Fix Audio and Pace

Keep music balanced, record voiceover in a quiet space, reduce noise, and aim for shots around 6 seconds.

Capture and Edit Tips

- + Light with a window or simple three-point lamp setup.
- + Use the rule of thirds and avoid dead-center framing by default.
- + Add motion with slow pans or a towel-slide phone move.
- + Cut to the music, use clean transitions, and balance audio carefully.
- + Aim for shots around 6 seconds and let pacing shape the emotion.

Workflow summary: plan the feeling, capture with intent, and shape the final rhythm in the edit.